

Left (top to bottom) “Dry” ribs, rubbed with a dry spice mix, are served with sauce on the side; “wet” ribs, cooked and served with sauce; a Texas barbecue pit with ribs and smoked sausage

Below (top to bottom) Grilled fish features on South African menus, where “linefish” simply means any fish caught by line from the sea; herding cattle in Brazil, where beef is king



MISSOURI

Kansas City’s sweet, thick barbecue sauce, made from molasses and tomatoes, is in a class of its own. A variety of meats are rubbed with spices, smoked over hickory wood, and smothered with sauce at the table.

Arthur Bryant’s Barbecue moderate
1727 Brooklyn Ave., Kansas City;
www.arthurbryantsbbq.com

Rated the best barbecue in Kansas City (if not the world), Arthur Bryant’s simple restaurant near the ballpark has been praised by baseball players and presidents for its delicious sauce.

B.B.’s Lawnside Bar-B-Q moderate
1205 E. 85th St., Kansas City;
<http://bbslawnsidebbq.com>

The “B.B.” stands for blues and beer, and here you’ll have a big helping of the former, either from live bands or from the blues-loving owners’ enormous collection of recordings, along with delicious slow-smoked ribs, pulled pork, beef, sausage, and chicken from the 60-year-old-barbecue pit.

Fiorella’s Jack Stack Barbecue expensive
101 W. 22nd St., Kansas City; www.jackstackbbq.com

The high ceilings and see-through fireplace in a converted freight house in the Crossroads Arts District make a stunning setting for this top-rated barbecue, cooked in hickory-fired brick ovens.

BRAZIL

In Brazil’s ranching region, the gauchos (cowboys) created their own style of barbecue, called *churrasco*. Try it in barbecue houses (*churrascaria rodizio*) around the country, where tender cuts of beef and other meats are grilled on long skewers over an open fire and served at your table, all-you-can-eat style.

Marius moderate
Av. Atlântica 290, Copacabana, Rio de Janeiro;
www.marius.com.br

A mouthwatering choice of some 30 grilled meats is accompanied here by an amazing salad bar with fresh seafood and side dishes, amid artifacts from antique ships and farms.

Barbacoa expensive
Rua Dr. Renato Paes de Barros 65, Itaim, São Paulo;
www.barbacoa.com.br

Serving over 20 scrumptious cuts of meats grilled without smoke over heated rocks, including wild boar

and the prized hump of the zebu, or Brahma steer, this popular barbecue house is great for vegetarians too, who can fill up on the extensive salad buffet.

Fogo de Chão expensive
Av. Moreira Guimarães 964, Moema, São Paulo;
www.fogodechao.com

An extensive wine list complements the delicious grilled meats and superb salad bar here. Of the three locations in the city, this one has stylish, contemporary decor and a lively atmosphere.

KENYA

Barbecue is popular throughout Africa. In Kenya, *nyama choma* (Kiswahili for roasted meat) is usually beef, goat, or mutton; it’s often ordered by weight. Be prepared, however, for even more unusual meats on some upmarket menus.

Summit Resort moderate
Lake Nakura National Park; +254 51 850 165
The open-air complex of lounge bars, dance floor, pool, and dining areas surrounding this friendly resort just outside the main entrance to the park includes a restaurant serving delicious *nyama choma*.

Carnivore expensive
Langata Road, Nairobi; www.tamarind.co.ke
Ostrich and crocodile are among the huge skewers of meats cooked on an enormous barbecue in the center of Kenya’s most famous restaurant. It’s served at your table by waiters in zebra-striped aprons.

SOUTH AFRICA

A South African braai, or pit barbecue, is a great social event where friends feast on steaks, lamb cutlets, and spicy sausage. The best restaurants serve up this relaxed, festive atmosphere along with good food.

Mama Africa moderate
178 Long Street, Cape Town; +27 21 424 8634
If you want to try roasted game meat, this is the place to find kudu, ostrich, springbok, and crocodile on the menu, with three African marimba bands providing a lively atmosphere.

Die Strandloper expensive
Langebaan, West Coast; www.strandloper.com
The delicious ten-course fish and seafood braai is cooked right on the beach at this informal restaurant. With the guitar music, the beach, and the endless stream of seafood, a meal lasts several hours.